Zachary Helfand

CONTACT

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Phonology, Non-concatenative Morphology, Computational Linguistics, Speech Perception, Semitic Languages

EDUCATION

Rutgers University
PhD Student, Linguistics, 2025-

Affiliations/Positions:

Linguistics Graduate Student Association (LGSA):

Secretary, 2025 - 2026

Treasurer, 2026 -

Washington University in St. Louis
Bachelor of Arts Degree with Honors, May 2025

Summa Cum Laude
Major: Linguistics
Minors: Computer Science, Psychological & Brain Sciences
GPA: 4.00
Honors Thesis: *False Hearing and L2 Accented Sentences*

RESEARCH

Invited Talks

Brown Bag, Behavior, Brain & Cognition, Department of Psychological & Brain Sciences, Washington University in St. Louis

Helfand, Z, *Dispatches on the Processing of Accented Speech* (2024)

Conference Presentations

2025: Helfand, Z and Van Engen, K. False hearing in L2-accented sentences. Acoustical Society of America, New Orleans, LA.

Research Assistant

2026: Subregular Inference of Morpho-phonology (NSF Award #2416184)
PIs: Adam Jardine, Jane Chandlee and Jeff Heinz

2022-2025: PsychLing Lab at Washington University in St. Louis
https://psychlinglab.weebly.com/
PI: Kristin Van Engen

Projects Worked On:

False hearing in L2-accented sentences: Project Lead

Vibrotactile Dual Task with L2 Accented Speech: Mel Mallard

Accent Effort Discounting: Assessing the challenge of accented speech using effort discounting: Grace Teuscher, Drew McLaughlin, Kristin Van Engen

Listen up: Children and Adults' Listening Effort for L2-accented speech: Ruth Altmiller (dissertation)

Roles: data collection, stimulus development, acoustic analysis, IPA transcription

Proofreading

(Under contract.) Adam Jardine and Paul de Lacy, editors, *The Cambridge Handbook of Phonology, Second Edition*. Cambridge University Press. Expected publication in 2026.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant

Introduction to Linguistics: Fall 2023
Professor: Nick Danis

Phonetics: Spring 2024, Spring 2025
Professor: Kristin Van Engen

LANGUAGES

English (native)
Hebrew (Conversational)

SKILLS

Java, Python, HTML, CSS, Praat, R, LaTeX